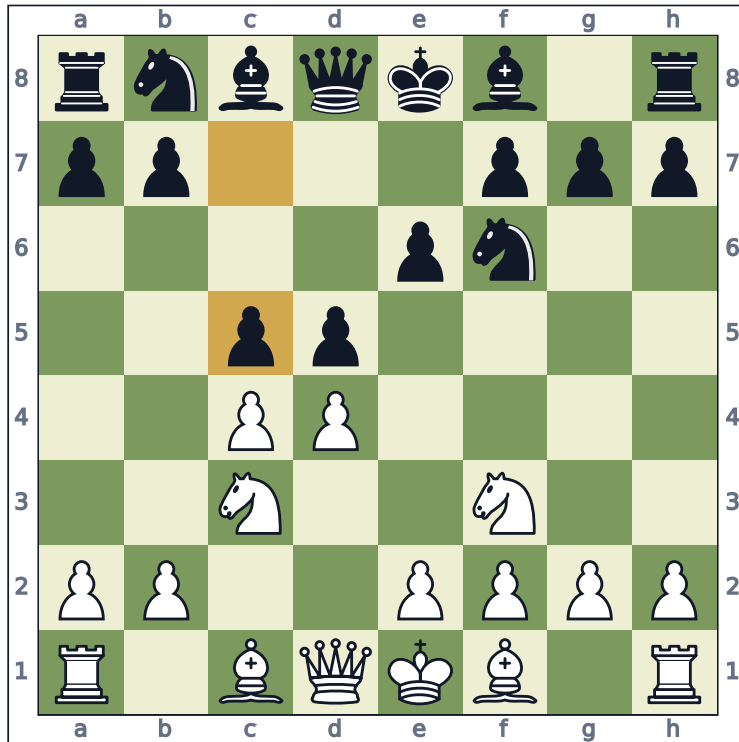


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D40 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.37 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D40 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D40 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to D40 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. e3 Nc6 6. a3 cxd4 7. exd4 Bd6

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Levenfish Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. e3 Nc6 6. Bd3 Bd6 7. O-O O-O 8. Qe2 Qe7 9. dxc5 Bxc5 10. e4

004 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Pillsbury Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. Bg5

005 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Symmetrical Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. e3 Nc6 6. Bd3 Bd6 7. O-O O-O

006 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, with e3

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c5 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nc6 6. Bd3